Laura Nettuno, PhD

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CURRENT POSITION

RAND Corporation, Associate Economist, *September 2025 to present*

SECONDARY AFFILIATIONS

Melbourne Institute, University of Melbourne, Honorary Research Affiliate, *March 2026 to present*
Development Policy Centre, Australian National University, Research Associate, *March 2026 to present*

EDUCATION

Vanderbilt University
Doctor of Philosophy in Economics, *2025*
Committee: Christopher ("Kitt") Carpenter (Chair), Marcus Dillender, Andrea Moro, Analisa Packham, Art Goldsmith

Vanderbilt University
Graduate Program in Economic Development (GPED)
Master of Arts in Economic Development, *2019*

James Madison University
Bachelor of Science in Economics, *2016*

Research fields: Applied microeconomics – Health, Labor, Development, LGBTQ+ economics, Crime

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Carpenter, C. S., Lee, M. J., & **Nettuno, L.** (2025). Gender Minority Status and Family Inequality in the United States. ***Russell Sage Foundation Journal in Social Sciences***.

Nettuno, L., Mann, S, & Gonzales G. (2024). Sexual orientation-based health disparities in Chile. ***PLOS ONE***.

Nettuno, L. (2024). Gender identity, labor market outcomes, and socioeconomic status: Evidence from Chile. ***Labour Economics***.

Tran, N. M., Mann, S., Cortez, M. G., Harrell, B., & **Nettuno, L.** (2023). Adverse childhood experiences (ACEs) and mental health by gender identity in the United States, 2019–2021. ***Preventive Medicine***.

Carpenter, C. S., Lee, M. J., & **Nettuno, L.** (2022). Economic outcomes for transgender people and other gender minorities in the United States: First estimates from a nationally representative sample. ***Southern Economic Journal***.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

"Effects of Workplace Anti-Discrimination Policies on Families: Evidence from 'Don't Ask, Don't Tell'" *(Revisions requested at the **Journal of Population Economics**)*

"Transgender Economics" – *with Travis Campell, Olivia Compton, and Karinna Saxby (Revisions requested at the **Journal of Economic Literature**)*

"In Sickness and in Health: The Consequences of Spousal Illness for Caregiver Health and Marital Stability" – *with Jenni Heissel*

"Kratom Use in the United States: Geography, Behavioral Health, and Access to Care" – *with Meghan Ballard, Codey Carr, and Rachel Sragovicz*

"Driving and Adolescent Arrests: Evidence from the Minimum Legal Driving Age" – *with Samuel Mann, August Morgan, Cathy Xue, and Nicholas Lovett*

RESEARCH FUNDING

Assessing the Feasibility of Evaluating Patient Safety Organizations in County Jails, Arnold Ventures; Value: $79,962; Role: Co-Principal Investigator (Other PI: Samuel Mann); 2027.

Psychedelic Drug Liberalization and Local Crime, Arnold Ventures; Value: $64,542; Role: Co-Investigator (PI: Samuel Mann); 2026.

LGBTQ+ Policy Lab Research Grant, Vanderbilt University LGBTQ+ Policy Lab, 2022

Kirk Dornbush Summer Research Grant, Vanderbilt University, Department of Economics, 2022

Graduate Fellowship, Vanderbilt University, College of Arts & Sciences, 2019-2025 (annually)

NON-ACADEMIC WRITING

"Transgender people face significant economic challenges," *IZA World of Labor, May 17, 2022. – with Christopher S. Carpenter and Maxine J. Lee*

MEDIA MENTIONS

Pennsylvania Capital Star, Health experts, lawmakers push for Pa. kratom regulation; proponents warn they'll fight a ban, Ian Karbal, 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lecturer, Vanderbilt University
- Mental Health Policy (Dr. Panka Bencsik)
- Field Research in Development Economics (Dr. Ana Regina Vides de Andrade)
- Introduction to Latin American Development (Dr. Ana Regina Vides de Andrade)

Teaching Assistant, Economics Department, Vanderbilt University – *August 2018 to May 2025*
- *Field Research in Development Economics – Master's level*
  - Jointly led field research trips to El Salvador, Costa Rica, and Argentina to teach students to collect data on multidimensional poverty.
- *Introduction to Latin American Development – Undergraduate level*

Tutor, Madison Economics Club, James Madison University – *August 2014 to May 2016*
- Tutored underclassmen in introductory micro and macroeconomics courses through Madison Economics Club.
- Tutored students in Calculus 1, Introduction to Econometrics, and Advanced Econometrics.

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Christopher ("Kitt") S. Carpenter, Vanderbilt University – *2021-2024*
- Multiple projects analyzing a variety of health- and labor-related topics; minimum legal drinking age laws, historical smoking laws, LGBT health policies, and the current landscape of LGBT economic research.
- Data analysis and visualization, literature review, background research.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CSRA (formerly, CSC) – *June 2015 to August 2017*
(This position required me to obtain and maintain a U.S. security clearance.)

- **Program Control Associate** *(May 2016 to August 2017)*
  Financial analysis for a large government contractor, including tracking and maintaining subcontractor labor for over 70 programs and 250 vendors, month-end accrued costs consolidation, monitoring payroll suspense accounts, and processing labor corrections.
- **Intern** *(June 2015 to May 2016)*

AWARDS

ASHEcon Diversity Scholarship, American Society of Health Economists, 2023

Award for Academic Excellence, Vanderbilt University, 2019

James S. and Rosemary Worley Award, Vanderbilt University, 2018

SERVICE, LEADERSHIP and ACTIVITIES

Student Representative, Council of Economics Graduate Students (CEGS), Vanderbilt University

- Helped plan and organize graduate student research and networking events.
- Reviewed and evaluated CEGS Research Grant Applications.

GPED Student Ambassador, Vanderbilt University Graduate School Fair

- Selected by program directors to be the student representative at graduate education informational event for undergraduate students.
- Answered questions about GPED requirements and gave a student's perspective on the program to prospective students.

Organizer, Graduate Life Coach: Conversation and Connection, Vanderbilt University

- Organized informational event with the Vanderbilt University Graduate Student Life Coach for GPED students.
- Facilitated discussion about the importance of mental health in graduate school.
- Provided information on resources available to Vanderbilt Students such as the Office of Student Care Coordination, the Center for Wellbeing, and the University Counseling Center.

Organizer, Fall Networking Event, Vanderbilt University

- Led and participated on a team to organize an interdisciplinary networking event for graduate students in: GPED, Center for Latin American Studies, Master of Public Health, and International Education and Policy Management.

Speaker, the Federal Reserve Challenge, James Madison University

- Presented an overview of the current state of the U.S. economy and monetary policy recommendations for the Federal Reserve Bank of the United States.
- First Place at the 2015 Regional Competition; Second Place at the 2015 District Competition.

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- Presenter – RAND Drug Policy Research Center Seminar Series, virtual seminar, 2026
- Presenter – 14th Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists, Nashville, TN 2025
- Presenter – QPAP Network Seminar Series, virtual seminar 2025
- Presenter – CSQIEP Seminar Series, virtual seminar 2024
- Presenter, Discussant – 94th Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, Washington, DC 2024
- Presenter – Association for Public Policy Administration and Management 2024 Fall Conference, National Harbor, MD 2024

- Presenter, Discussant – 93rd Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, New Orleans, LA 2023
- Discussant – 2024 Allied Social Science Associations Conference, San Antonio, TX 2024
- Presenter, Discussant – 12th Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists, St. Louis, MO 2023
- Non-presenting Author – Russell Sage Foundation Conference on "U.S. Census 2020: Continuity and Change," New York, NY 2023
- Presenter, Discussant – 92nd Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, Ft. Lauderdale, FL 2022
- Presenter – Institute of National Affairs, Port Moresby, Papua New Guinea, 2022
- Presenter – 2022 Pacific Update Conference, Suva, Fiji, 2022
- Presenter – Eastern Economic Association Conference, Montego Bay, Jamaica 2022
- Presenter – Association for Public Policy Administration and Management 2021 Fall Conference (delayed due to COVID), Austin, TX 2022
- Attendee – NBER Health Economics Program Meeting, Cambridge, MA 2021
- Presenter – 91st Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, Houston, TX 2021
- Discussant – 90th Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, Virtual 2020
- Attendee – 89th Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, Ft. Lauderdale, FL 2019
- Attendee – 88th Annual Meetings of the Southern Economic Association, D.C. 2018

JOURNAL REFEREE SERVICE

- Labour Economics
- Applied Economics Letters
- Feminist Economics

SKILLS

- Stata, R, SAS, LaTeX, Excel, Mendeley, ArcGIS, QGIS
- Spanish, proficient